INDUSTRY RESEARCH

Billings fell to 44.7 in September. Set 2027 AI spend on that number.

SWIPE

THE NUMBERS

Inquiries up, signed contracts down, 6.2 months of backlog

The AIA/Deltek Architecture Billings Index came in at 44.7 for September 2026, down from 47.2 in August, with the largest share of firms reporting declining billings since May. Below 50 means more firms reported declines than increases. New project inquiries rose to 53.2 while the value of newly signed design contracts fell to 43.7, so conversations are not turning into work. Backlogs averaged 6.2 months at the end of the third quarter. Source: AIA/Deltek ABI, September 2026, released October 21, 2026.

AECENTRIC

Plan 2027 AI spend on real demand

Two places to put it: the proposal stage, where inquiries are up and contracts are down, so measure pursuit hours and turnaround; and booked work, where 6.2 months of backlog ships with the team you have. One workflow in each, hours before and after. No platform for demand that has not signed.

Full breakdown at the link in bio.